

New Generation English Test

Academic Entrance Diagnostic

Level	C1 - Advanced Academic
Skills assessed	Reading, Listening, Writing, Speaking, Grammatical Range and Accuracy
Format	Academic entrance diagnostic test

Reading

Assessment as interpretation rather than measurement

Educational progress is often treated as if it must be visible, numerical and immediate. Test scores, attendance charts and completion rates are attractive because they create the impression of control. Yet the most important changes in learning may be indirect: a student begins to tolerate uncertainty, notices patterns, asks better questions or becomes less dependent on translation. These shifts are difficult to measure, but they often explain later improvement.

This does not mean that assessment is useless. On the contrary, careful assessment can make invisible progress easier to discuss. The danger appears when numbers become the aim rather than the evidence. A diagnostic test should therefore be read as a map, not a verdict. It shows where the learner is now, which strategies are available and what kind of support is likely to be productive. A strong diagnostic process also accepts asymmetry. One learner may write accurately but speak cautiously; another may understand sophisticated texts yet produce repetitive grammar.

The teacher's task is to interpret these patterns without turning them into a fixed identity. Feedback should be specific enough to guide action and humane enough to keep the learner moving. In this sense, diagnosis is not a gatekeeping ritual. It is a professional conversation about direction.

01

What does the author criticise?

- A. All forms of assessment.
 - B. Students who ask questions.
 - C. The obsession with immediately visible measurement.
-

02	Which example of invisible progress is mentioned? A. Winning a prize. B. Memorising all rules. C. Tolerating uncertainty. _____
03	What is the danger of numbers? A. They are always inaccurate. B. They cannot be discussed. C. They can become the aim rather than evidence. _____
04	What does map, not a verdict imply? A. Maps are more beautiful than scores. B. Tests should be removed. C. Diagnostics should guide routes, not define identity. _____
05	What is asymmetry in this context? A. A mathematical concept only. B. A sign of failure. C. Different strengths across skills. _____
06	What should feedback do? A. Sound severe and final. B. Avoid concrete comments. C. Guide action and keep the learner moving. _____

07

What is the author's view of assessment?

- A. Completely useless.
- B. Only useful for attendance.
- C. Useful when interpreted carefully.

08

What genre is the text closest to?

- A. Personal diary.
- B. Advertisement.
- C. Reflective academic argument.

Listening

Academic discussion of diagnostic labels

Audio track: open this level on the website and press Play audio: female / male voices. The transcript is not printed in the student PDF.

01 Why can the word level be dangerous?

- A. It is never convenient.
 - B. It has no practical use.
 - C. It hides important differences.
-

02 What does the lecturer say about labels?

- A. They are always false.
 - B. They replace diagnosis.
 - C. They may be broadly accurate but incomplete.
-

03 What example does the student give?

- A. Perfect writing and no reading.
 - B. No vocabulary at all.
 - C. Fluent speaking but inaccurate writing.
-

04 What is the diagnostic question?

- A. Which label sounds better.
 - B. How fast the test can end.
 - C. What support the pattern suggests.
-

05 What should a responsible teacher do?

- A. Never use labels.
 - B. Give only a score.
 - C. Keep the label provisional.
-

06	What does provisional mean here? A. Completely random. B. Officially certified. C. Open to revision.
07	What is the relationship between label and conversation? A. The label replaces it. B. The conversation should avoid evidence. C. The label begins it; it should not end it.
08	What is the tone? A. Sarcastic and hostile. B. Purely narrative. C. Nuanced and analytical.

Writing

TOEFL Integrated/IELTS academic-style task. Write 240-300 words: A diagnostic score should show what to work on next rather than act as a verdict. Discuss the advantages and risks of this view, using examples from language learning.

Speaking

Record 3 minutes. Explain why two learners with the same CEFR label may need different learning routes. Include examples across reading, listening, writing, speaking and grammar.

Record your answer on the website or prepare an audio file for the teacher.

Preparation notes

Grammatical Range and Accuracy

01 Had the assessment been interpreted narrowly, it ____ the learner's confidence.

- A. might damage
- B. will damage
- C. might have damaged

02 The label is useful, ____ incomplete.

- A. despite
- B. whereas
- C. albeit

03 It is vital that feedback ____ actionable.

- A. is
- B. will be
- C. be

04 What matters most ____ the pattern behind the score.

- A. are
- B. being
- C. is

05 The learner appears ____ stronger control in writing.

- A. having developed
- B. to developing
- C. to have developed

06	Given the limited sample, conclusions should ____ cautiously. A. interpret B. interpreting C. be interpreted _____
07	Not until later ____ the asymmetry. A. we noticed B. we did notice C. did we notice _____
08	The teacher's role is less to classify ____ to interpret. A. rather B. instead C. than _____
09	A score may obscure differences, ____ convenient it seems. A. despite B. whereas C. however _____
10	The task, ____ designed for advanced learners, was accessible. A. despite B. because C. although _____

11	Learners differ in the extent ____ they tolerate uncertainty. A. where B. what C. to which _____
12	The feedback was specific enough ____ action. A. guiding B. guide C. to guide _____
13	Far from being useless, assessment ____ discussion. A. is enabling to B. enable C. enables _____
14	The more nuanced the feedback, ____ useful the route. A. more B. most C. the more _____
15	No single task can account ____ the whole learner. A. about B. of C. for _____

16	The result should not be mistaken ____ identity. A. as B. to C. for _____
17	The student wrote accurately, ____ cautiously. A. despite spoke B. whereby speaking C. yet spoke _____
18	If numbers become the aim, evidence ____ distorted. A. will have B. would have been C. becomes _____
19	The process requires not only measurement ____ interpretation. A. and also B. whereas C. but also _____
20	A learner may understand complex texts while ____ repetitive grammar. A. produce B. to produce C. producing _____

21

The conclusion is tentative, ____ still useful.

- A. despite
 - B. whereas
 - C. yet
-

22

Teachers should avoid ____ patterns into fixed identities.

- A. to turn
 - B. turn
 - C. turning
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